Dojo Playbook: Applying the Insights to PETL & NOBL

Oct 25, 2026 · @Grace

The core rule from the dojo: copy what's already working as closely as you can, and let the data pick the formats. Everything below came out of the Icy Bear thread (Oct 2026). It's applied here to PETL (the MagSafe battery pack) and NOBL Travel (the all-in-one carry-on).

1. Swipe what's working, and swipe it closely

Rip the winning ad almost shot for shot. Change only the product, the avatar and the reason why. Search in this order: your own niche, then adjacent niches, then brands selling to the same ICP even if the product is different.

Search	PETL	NOBL
Own niche	Power banks, MagSafe accessories	Carry-ons, hard-shell luggage
Adjacent niche	Phone cases, chargers, tech gifts, desk setup and "what's in my bag" creators	Packing cubes, travel pillows, backpacks, travel tech
Same ICP	Commuters, students, festival-goers	Frequent flyers: travel apps, credit cards, airport lounges

2. Formats vs concepts

A format is the vehicle. A concept is what goes inside it. Most of what we call formats are really concepts, so we miss whole vehicles.

- **Formats:** skeletons, Pixar-style stories, cartoon characters, street interviews, skits, follow-my-journey, whitelisted influencer, native pages.
- **Concepts/structures:** 3 reasons why, testimonial, transformation timeline, us vs them, myth-bust.

Keep a running list of formats that are scaling across the market (ask Iason for his). Each batch, check which ones PETL and NOBL haven't tried yet.

3. Let the data make the case to the client

When a client pushes a format that isn't working, answer with numbers, not opinions.

1. Pull the last 3 months and split spend and ROAS by format and by who's on screen.
2. Answer two questions:
    a. Outside our usual formats, where are we most likely to find a winner?
    b. For the format the client wants, is there a pattern in why it's failed?
3. Take a plan built on that to the client.
4. If they still insist, negotiate it down to the smallest share of the batch. Revisit every 3 months.

NOBL: it's a newer brand and retention matters, so start this habit now. A monthly "here's what the data says" slide builds trust fast.

4. Mine your own winners for the pattern

The top 10 ads usually tell one story. Find it, then find a brand doing that same pattern better and rip them.

At Icy Bear, the top 10 shared four things:

- An authority face (founder or influencer).
- A dream-outcome payoff: "people think I've had work done."
- An on-camera routine demo.
- Scarcity.

Only the top 10 matter for this. Mid and low performers add noise, not direction.

5. Real customers on camera

Book a quick call with a real reviewer and get their story. Write a script from their own words, then have them film it sitting and talking to camera. T-Man says this has worked really well for him.

- **PETL:** reviewers with a specific moment, like the phone dying at a gig or the battery saving them at an airport.
- **NOBL:** reviewers with a story, like a bag surviving a dozen flights, or never checking a bag again.

6. Follow-my-journey check-ins

These are episodic check-ins with a personal reason behind them, like "Here's where I started, here's where I am now, check back next month." Keep them to real use, not invented stories, so they stay inside Meta's rules.

- **NOBL (best fit):** "Trip 1 vs trip 6 with the same carry-on." Or a countdown: "Packing for 2 weeks in one bag."
- **PETL:** "A week of never hitting 0%," filmed as a daily battery check-in.

7. Make the mechanism visceral

Turn the feature into something people feel instantly. At Icy Bear that was "peroxide = bleach." Find the image that makes the alternative feel bad.

- **PETL:** the panic at 5% battery. Or a clean magnetic snap vs a bag full of tangled cables.
- **NOBL:** a broken zip or a cracked shell at baggage claim. Or paying £60 for a checked bag vs fitting everything in a carry-on.

8. Authority and trust beat anonymous creators

If a founder or a famous face is what's winning, the audience wants someone it trusts. Swap in other authority figures rather than more generic UGC. The "expert rates X" format travels well between categories.

- **PETL:** tech reviewers, or "phone repair guy rates power banks."
- **NOBL:** flight attendants, pilots, frequent-flyer creators. For example, "flight attendant reacts to carry-ons."

9. Check the funnel before blaming the creative

If TOF ads aren't converting, check where they land before writing them off.

- Do TOF and BOF ads go to the same page? A page built for buyers can lose cold traffic.
- Is tracking working on the TOF landing page?
- Is the funnel built around one face (celebrity, founder)? That can drag down every non-founder ad.

10. Don't force AI formats

AI formats (skeletons, cartoons, Pixar stories) are scaling hard for some brands, but not every audience responds. Test one per batch at most, and rip a proven one closely.

- **PETL:** a younger tech audience, so probably more open to AI formats.
- **NOBL:** depends on the core buyer. Check the age split before testing.

Batch checklist

- [ ] Top 10 ads from the last 3 months reviewed for the shared pattern
- [ ] At least one close rip from the brand's own niche
- [ ] At least one rip from an adjacent niche or a same-ICP brand
- [ ] One format the brand hasn't tried yet
- [ ] One authority-led concept (expert, reviewer, influencer)
- [ ] One real-customer or follow-my-journey concept
- [ ] Max one AI format
- [ ] Landing page and tracking checked for TOF ads